

SCULPTER LA VOÛTE

At nightfall, the forest vibrates, oscillating with the jerky and irregular rhythm of the sap circulation and the dilation of the wood vessels. Just as the aorta pulsates with the rhythm of the blood flow, so the living wood swells at night when its cells become waterlogged. It is the subsonic forest drone.

In the hands of a violin maker, the «dead» wood becomes animated again thanks to the vibration of sound. The craftsman auscultates it with the pulp of his fingers or taps it with his knuckles. The caress, the movement of the fingers on the wood creates a vibration that the material sends back, the wood responds, it is the wood that guides the craftsman in the making process of the instrument.

The groups of receptors in the form of bulbs, discs and sensory spindles are embedded in the upper and deep layers of the fingers' skin. They react to light touch, feel slippery movements or prolonged pressure. Hearing the messages of the fibres through the touch is what some craftsmen call *developing another sense*. «The violin maker gives the trees what Japanese carpenters call a second life, which can be as long and rich as the first.»

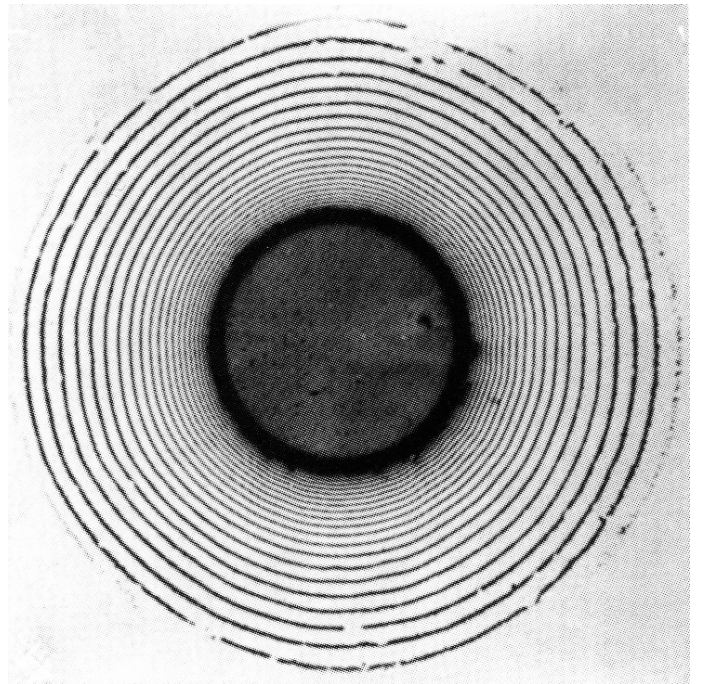
The multichannel sound installation «Sculpter la voûte» proposes to discover the path from the living tree set in vibration by the circulation of sap, to the wood animated by the auscultations of a violin maker, and finally resonating with sound in the hands of an instrumentalist. Throughout this journey into the intimacy of the relationship with the wood, unusual sound experiences are revealed: to feel the vibration of the forest, to follow a violin maker breathing new life into the wood material, to hear how a musician perceives his own instrument.

Thanks to the modification of the hearing scale, the spatialization of this compositional work will let the listener feel inside the wood material itself, be part of the experience rather than an its external spectator.

The ICST Ambisonics studio residency during the compositional period would allow me to concentrate on the spatial dimension of sound that is essential not only for the described project, but more generally for the totality of my artistic work.

The text of the project was inspired by the readings of the book «The Songs of Trees» by David George Haskell, Flammarion, 2017

The sound installation «Sculpter la voûte» is a parallel project to the exploratory and compositional work with the Patricia Bosshard's string quartet with percussion and electronics which will be publicly presented during residencies and concerts in 2021.



PROJECT SCHEDULE

late autumn 2020: recording sessions with Christian Guidetti, violin maker, Locarno

https://metiersdart.ch/it_CH/mestieri-d-arte/repertorio-dei-artigiani-d-arte/guidetti-christian

early spring 2021: outdoor recordings of the ascent of sap

march 2021 - december 2021: compositional work & public presentations